

LILAINIE ADJEI-ADDO

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A connector at heart, a strategist by skill.

SUMMARY OF QUALIFICATIONS

I am someone who approaches everything with two core concepts: the researcher's instinct to understand what is happening beyond the surface, and the creator's drive to make it visible and tangible. Having navigated my way through communities across four countries, I bring a fluency to people and systems that comes only from the duality of existing as an immigrant and a resident. A full-cycle creative with a behavioural science foundation, I operate from analytical thinking through to final production. My goal is building infrastructure that is data-informed, equitable and built to last.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Community & Equity Practice:** Trauma-Informed, Anti-Racist & Equity-Centred Practice | LGBTQI2S+-Informed Service Delivery | Harm Reduction Principles | Social Determinants of Health (SDOH) | Wrap-Around Service Coordination | Warm Referral & Service Navigation | Client & Caregiver Education and Self-Advocacy | FIPPA/PHIPA-Compliant Client Documentation
- **Program Delivery & Community Engagement:** Direct Service & Individual Advocacy | Workshop Facilitation & Curriculum Delivery | Community Mobilization | Cross-Sector Workshops & Partnerships | Staff, Practicum & Volunteer Supervision | Youth, Senior & Newcomer Community Programming | Cultural Interpretation & Navigation | Micro Budget & Expense Tracking | Microsoft 365 | Power Automate
- **Research, Evaluation & Reporting:** Mixed-Methods Program Evaluation | Focus Groups & Semi-Structured Interviews | Thematic Analysis | REB Ethics Documentation | Technical & Plain Language Stakeholder Reporting | Literature Synthesis | PHIPA-Compliant Data Management | TCPS Core 2 | First Aid/CPR
- **Global Health & Communications:** International Health Equity Advocacy (UN SDGs) | Cross-Cultural Stakeholder Communication | Health Promotion Content Development & Plain Language Writing | AODA-Compliant Content Delivery | MailChimp | Canva | WordPress | Hootsuite | Adobe Creative Suite | DaVinci Resolve | CapCut | English (fluent) | Twi, Ghanaian dialect (fluent).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Community Mobilization Worker

July 2025 – March 2026

Skills for Change, Toronto

- Led intake, assessment, and direct service delivery for 340+ participants annually across four concurrent program streams serving Black, newcomer, youth, and senior communities, coordinating 18 external facilitators to ensure every client received support grounded in their cultural context and circumstance. The programs exceeded funder targets and improved client engagement and retention, a contribution the organization recognized with the 2025 Citizenship Award for exceptional community spirit and humanitarian leadership.
- Ran a full volunteer pipeline for programming, building recruitment forms, reaching out to the community and past clients to source interested candidates, screening applicants, and onboarding and training a rotating group of 2–7 volunteers on client support protocols and program compliance. Onboarded and integrated contract workshop facilitators into the documentation, data tracking, and communication infrastructure I had built, ensuring their work maintained compliance and fed accurately into program outcomes. Practicum students who came through were supported in the same capacity.
- Built and maintained the operational backbone of the program, rebuilding documentation standards from the ground up and managing expense tracking to ensure funder-ready data quality that accurately reflected program delivery. The infrastructure scaled with the program's growth without losing integrity.

Youth Community Worker, Black Community Access Programs (BCAP)

July 2024 – May 2025

Skills for Change, Toronto

- Delivered direct service for Black youth aged 14 to 18 across a long-term 8-week STEM program, facilitating workshops and providing individual advocacy grounded in each young person's circumstances, including designing a Science of Social Media workshop from scratch in direct response to what participants needed. Registrations doubled the cohort's capacity, and by completion, each participant reported the program had made a meaningful difference for them, with 96.43% saying it increased their motivation toward future STEM careers.
- Redesigned BCAP's operational infrastructure from the ground up with an incoming manager, building filing systems, documentation templates, intake forms, and integrated data tracking systems where no structured process had previously existed. Self-taught Power Automate to reduce our team's manual administrative burden, then trained colleagues so the improvements continued after the cohort ended.

- Managed the full program ecosystem as primary contact to parents and youth across the 8-week cycle, overseeing 10 volunteers and 2 practicum students while coordinating field trips, preparing status reports, and maintaining active engagement with institutional partners including York University, Accenture, and Urban Pilots Network. That sustained investment was formally recognized when a participant nominated me for the Council of African Professionals Youth Leadership Award (2025).

**Administration Trainee, Toronto Water
City of Toronto, Toronto**

June 2024 – July 2024

- Performed data entry and records management using the division's CRM and administrative software, accurately logging service requests, billing disputes, and resident inquiries across a high-volume intake operation. That data trail was what dispatch teams relied on to track open cases and allocate technicians in real time during an active city-wide pipe crisis.
- Handled public call and email inquiries for Toronto Water residents navigating service disruptions and billing disputes, moving each case from intake through ticket creation and technician booking to resolution. Managing a high volume of competing priorities in a fast-paced municipal government environment built practical fluency in public service administration under real operational pressure.

**Research & Program Coordination Assistant, Mac iSTEP
McMaster University, Hamilton**

June 2024 – July 2024

- Coordinated logistics, documentation, and stakeholder communication for participants in an academic health program compressed, keeping REB ethics submissions, longitudinal tracking, and faculty-participant communication on schedule throughout.
- Produced dual-format evaluation reports at program close, translating findings into technical summaries for faculty and plain language write-ups for non-specialist audiences to be presented to faculty leadership.

**Health Communications Assistant, Student Wellness Centre
McMaster University, Hamilton**

September 2022 – April 2024

- Translated clinical research into plain language health promotion content for a campus of 37,000+ students, maintaining a 93% first-review approval rate across digital channels over two years.
- Led co-branded community health campaigns in partnership with Hamilton Health Sciences, sustaining a two-year publishing cycle across all campus digital channels.
- Shot, edited, and delivered clinical staff training videos for McMaster Student Wellness, managing the full production cycle from camera work through post-production in Adobe Creative Suite.

**Research Assistant, McMaster Aerial Lab
Hamilton General Hospital, Hamilton**

April 2022 – August 2022

- Coordinated data collection for a medically complex EEG cohort at Hamilton General Hospital, providing direct patient support and maintaining PHIPA-compliant records in REDCap under active Hamilton Health Sciences clinical protocols.
- Co interpreted the data with the graduate team and supervisors for reporting and foundation needed in a longitudinal study tracking neurological outcomes in patients in comatose states.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

**BASc. Honours Applied Science in Human Behaviour
McMaster University, Hamilton**

June 2024

- **Honours Thesis with distinction;** a mixed-methods study examining anti-Black racism in psychiatric care, co managing the research lifecycle from REB ethics approval through qualitative interviews with communities, thematic analysis, and a final write-up grounded in health, social justice and anti-oppression frameworks.
- Award of Excellence Scholarship recipient (2020).

VOLUNTEER

**Research Advisory Committee Member
MLSE Foundation (LaunchPad), Toronto**

May 2025 – Present

- Contribute research methodology and community health expertise to the MLSE Foundation LaunchPad Research Advisory Committee, shaping evidence-based programming decisions for youth facing systemic barriers at one of Canada's largest sport-based social impact organizations.

**Child Life Volunteer
SickKids Hospital, Toronto**

April 2025 – Present

- Provide patient and family support through play and respite in an active inpatient academic teaching hospital, working alongside Child Life Specialists and multidisciplinary clinical teams during some of the most difficult moments in a family's life.